Board of Education Meeting

October 20, 2026



PORTLAND
Public Schools

Meeting starts at 6:00 PM

Superintendent's Report

TOGETHER, *WE RISE*

October 20, 2026



Closing school buildings is not about reducing the deficit. It is about concentrating resources to strengthen educational opportunities for students with fewer available dollars.

2027-28 Enrollment Forecast

Actual and state-funded student counts are expected to drop from FY2026-27:

Actual Daily Membership (ADMr): Decreasing from 42,312 to 41,164*

Weighted Enrollment (Extended ADMw): Decreasing from 51,312 to 49,793*

*Early Preliminary Data

Why we're here today

$65M

General Fund reduction for 2027-28

Runs alongside Rightsizing. Central decisions come first; staffing workgroup provides recommendations, final staffing selections from schools begins January 2027.

Rising costs

Inflation, investments in compensation and teacher planning time, and rising PERS costs

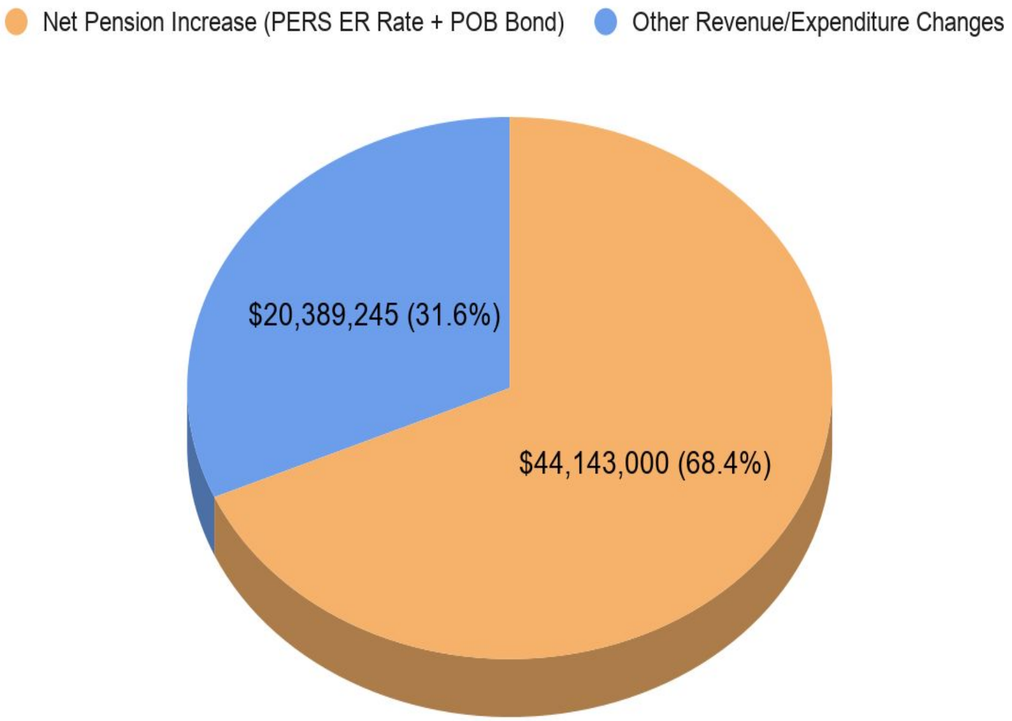
Limited revenue

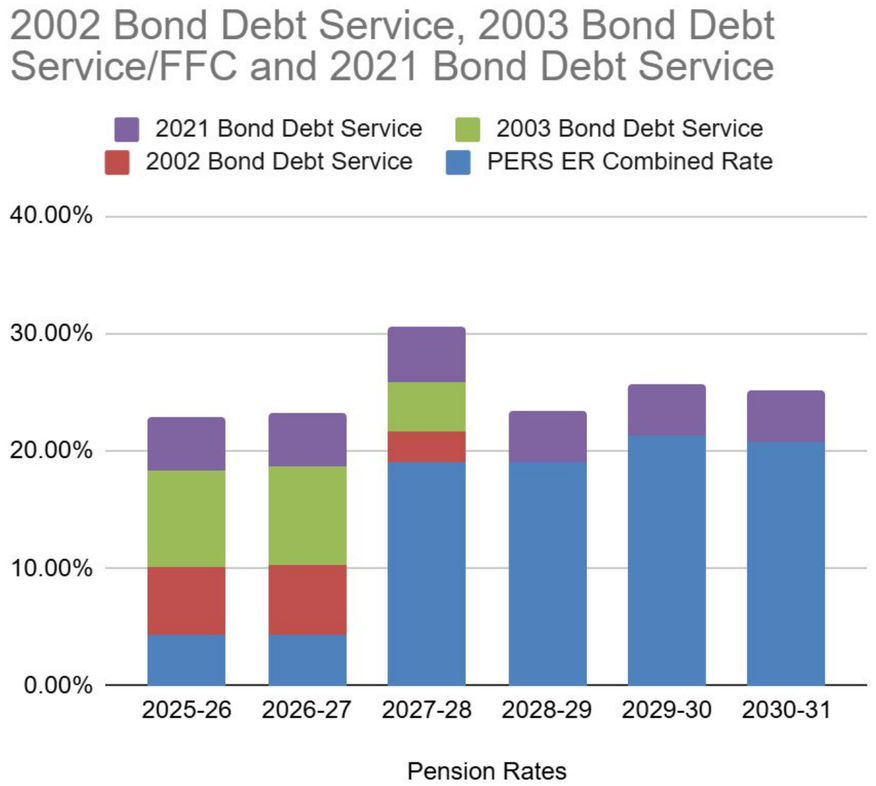
State funding falls short of operating costs, and federal pandemic aid has ended

Declining enrollment

Down 9.5% since 2020, faster than Oregon's 6%, with the same number of buildings

What is driving the budget gap?





Planned Reductions

$65M Target Distribution	Proportionate Share 8.1%	Additional 5% to Building/Central Office
Operations	$10,296,986	$13,546,986
Central Office	$6,318,953	$9,568,953
Specialized Programs (Special Education, MPG)	$12,819,317	$9,569,317
Schools	$35,564,744	$32,314,744
	$65,000,000	**$65,000,000**

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How Different Scenarios Impact Our Schools

The same $65 million budget challenge leads to different impacts depending on whether we close school buildings and capture operational savings.



Status Quo

No school closures

$32.3 million

reduction needed from schools

223

potential FTE positions reduced

Not applicable

No buildings are closed, so there are no operational savings to reinvest.

Key Takeaway

Without closing buildings, we would need to reduce the equivalent of 223 positions from our schools.



Scenario A

14 school closures

$18.3 million

reduction needed from schools

126

potential FTE positions reduced

97 FTE

potentially preserved or reinvested

Key Takeaway

By closing 14 schools and capturing an estimated $14 million in operational savings, we could potentially preserve or reinvest the equivalent of 97 positions.



Scenario B

11 school closures

$21.3 million

reduction needed from schools

147

potential FTE positions reduced

76 FTE

potentially preserved or reinvested

Key Takeaway

By closing 11 schools and capturing an estimated $11 million in operational savings, we could potentially preserve or reinvest the equivalent of 76 positions.

What this means

Closing school buildings does not eliminate all reductions, but it reduces the impact on school staffing.
It allows us to concentrate resources and potentially preserve more positions for students with fewer available dollars.

Scenario Comparisons

School Portion of Budget Reductions	Reduction Target	Potential Reinvestment in FTE Equivalent	FTE Equivalent
Status Quo	**- $32,314,744**	**+ 0.0 FTE**	**- 223.0 FTE**
Scenario A (14 School Closures)	**- $18,314,744**	**+ 96.7 FTE**	**- 126.3 FTE**
Scenario B (11 School Closures)	**- $21,314,744**	**+ 76.0 FTE**	**- 147.0 FTE**

Scenarios A & B show the reduction target with equivalent FTE based on estimated operational savings of $14 and $11 million dollars.
Licensed FTE are estimated at $145,000.

Follow along on social!

TOGETHER, WE *RISE*

WITH **EXCELLENCE.** WITH **PURPOSE.**